Curriculum Vitae

Shaolin Pu

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EDUCATION

- Ph.D. in *Analytics, Information and Operations*, University of Kansas, Expected May 2027
  Committee: Ben Sherwood (Co-Chair), Karthik Srinivasan (Co-Chair), Arvind Tripathi, Suman Mallik, and Yexin Jessica Li
- M.S. in *Business Analytics and Information Systems*, University of South Florida
- M.S. in *Management*, University of South Florida
- B.S. in *Systems Science and Engineering*, University of Shanghai for Science and Technology, Shanghai, China

RESEARCH

Research Interests

Topics: Digital Economy; Digital Platforms and Platform Operations (Crowdfunding, E-Commerce, and Sharing Economy); Technology-Enabled Operations; Artificial Intelligence, and AI Agents in Digital Markets; Human-AI Collaboration in Business.

Methodologies: Econometrics and Causal Inference, Experimental Design, Machine Learning, NLP and LLM-Based Text Analysis, Analytical and Optimization Modeling.

Dissertation

The dissertation, titled "*Essays on Project Creator Strategies in Reward-Based Crowdfunding"*, consists of three essays. Defense expected Spring 2027.

1. "*Through the Lens of Creator Type: The Effects of Informational and Relational Messaging on Funding Outcomes in Reward-Based Crowdfunding*" with Ben Sherwood, Karthik Srinivasan, and Arvind Tripathi.
   - Under review at ***Information Systems Research***.
   - Conference presentations:
     - Midwest Association for Information Systems Conference (MWAIS), 2022.
     - International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS), 2023.
     - DSI Annual Conference, 2026 (scheduled).

   Abstract: Drawing on signaling theory, this study examines how informational and relational messaging affect crowdfunding performance for individual versus organizational creators. Analyzing 17,363

Kickstarter campaigns with survey-validated text measures built via natural language processing (NLP) and large language models (LLMs), the results show that informational messaging is more effective for organizational creators while relational messaging is more rewarded for individual creators, suggesting that effective communication requires aligning message emphasis with creator type.

2. *"Spillover or Starvation? Effects of Blockbuster Projects in Reward-Based Crowdfunding"* with Ben Sherwood, Karthik Srinivasan, and Arvind Tripathi.
    - Under review at ***Information Systems Research***.
    - Conference presentations:
        - AMA Summer Academic Conference, 2024.
        - Pre-ICIS SIGDSA Symposium, 2025.

    Abstract: Drawing on cross-side network effects and category legitimation arguments, this study examines whether blockbuster projects monopolize backer resources or expand the market on crowdfunding platforms. Using a stacked difference-in-differences (DiD) design on 128,757 Kickstarter projects covering 103 blockbuster events, the results show that blockbuster emergence increases project launches, backer counts, and pledged amounts in the same category, especially among first-time creators.

3. *"Riding the Wave, Dodging the Crowd: How Competing Goals Shape Launch Timing in Reward-Based Crowdfunding"* with Ben Sherwood, Karthik Srinivasan, and Arvind Tripathi.
    - In preparation for submission to *Production and Operations Management* (expected Fall 2026).
    - Conference presentations and doctoral programs:
        - INFORMS Annual Meeting, 2025.
        - HICSS Doctoral Fellows Program and Doctoral Consortium, 2026.
        - POMS Annual Conference, 2026.

    Abstract: This study examines how competitive pressure shapes creators' launch timing on crowdfunding platforms across two goals: raising brand awareness versus maximizing pledged amounts. Analyzing day-level launch behavior across 184,537 Kickstarter projects, the results show that creators launch alongside mega competitors to gain visibility but avoid intense competition to protect funding, and that such avoidance increases pledged amounts.

Papers Under Review

4. Karthik Srinivasan, Jinhang Jiang, **Shaolin Pu**, and Mei Feng, *"Forecasting Market Uncertainty with Guided Concepts from Personal-Finance Forums."* Prepare for third-round review at ***Journal of the Association for Information Systems (JAIS)***.
5. Bhumika Gupta, **Shaolin Pu**, and Karthik Srinivasan, *"The Survival of the Smartest: Tracking the Rapid Evolution of Large Language Models."* Under review at ***Technological Forecasting and Social Change (TFSC)***.

Work-in-Progress

6. **Shaolin Pu** and Suman Mallik, "*When Does Crowdfunding Outperform Amazon Launchpad? A Comparative Analysis Using Newsvendor and (Q,R) Inventory Models."*
7. **Shaolin Pu** and Arvind Tripathi, *"A New Middleman? AI Agents and Double Marginalization in Digital Platform Markets."*

Refereed Conference Publications

1. **Pu, S.,** Srinivasan, K., Sherwood, B., & Tripathi, A. "How High-Profile Projects Shape Creator Influx on Reward-Based Crowdfunding Platforms." *Proceedings of 2025 Pre-ICIS SIGDSA Symposium*, Nashville, Tennessee (December 2025).
2. **Pu, S.,** Srinivasan, K., Sherwood, B., & Tripathi, A. "Should Creators Delay Their Project Launches? Analyzing the Blockbuster Effect on Reward-Based Crowdfunding." *Proceedings of 2024 AMA Summer Academic Conference*, Boston, Massachusetts (August 2024).
3. **Pu, S.,** Srinivasan, K., Sherwood, B., & Tripathi, A. "Does Narrative Impact Funding? Analyzing the Relationship Between Project Description and Pledged Amounts for Reward-Based Crowdfunding Projects." *Proceedings of 44th International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS)*, Hyderabad, India (December 2023).
4. **Pu, S.,** & Srinivasan, K. "Are Project Narrative Attributes Indicative of Pre-Order Campaign Success on Crowdfunding Platforms? A Text-Mining Approach." *Proceedings of 17th Midwest Association for Information Systems Conference (MWAIS)*, Omaha, Nebraska (May 2022).

Conference and Workshop Presentations

1. "When Does Crowdfunding Outperform Amazon Launchpad? A Comparative Analysis Using Newsvendor and (Q,R) Inventory Models." *2026 DSI Annual Conference, San Francisco, California* (Scheduled November 2026).
2. "When Individuals Compete with Organizations: Messaging Strategies and Funding Outcomes in Reward-Based Crowdfunding." *2026 DSI Annual Conference, San Francisco, California* (Scheduled November 2026).
3. "Strategic Timing in Crowdfunding: How Competition Shapes Launch Decisions Across Creator Types." *2026 POMS Annual Conference, Reno, Nevada* (May 2026).
4. "Where Should Creators Launch? A Newsvendor Approach to Crowdfunding and E-Commerce Platform Selection." *2026 POMS Annual Conference, Reno, Nevada* (May 2026).
5. "Strategic Timing in Crowdfunding: Effect of Competition on Project Launch Decisions." ***The Eighth Doctoral Fellows Program and Doctoral Consortium****, 59th Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences (HICSS), Maui, Hawaii* (January 2026).
6. "How High-Profile Projects Shape Creator Influx on Reward-Based Crowdfunding Platforms." *2025 Pre-ICIS SIGDSA Symposium*, *Nashville, Tennessee* (December 2025).

7. "Strategic Timing in Crowdfunding: Effect of Competition on Project Launch Decisions." *2025 INFORMS Annual Meeting*, *Atlanta, Georgia* (October 2025).
8. "Should Creators Delay Their Project Launches? Analyzing the Blockbuster Effect on Reward-Based Crowdfunding." *2024 AMA Summer Academic Conference*, *Boston, Massachusetts* (August 2024).
9. "Does Narrative Impact Funding? Analyzing the Relationship Between Project Description and Pledged Amounts for Reward-Based Crowdfunding Projects." *44th International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS), Hyderabad, India* (December 2023).
10. "Are Project Narrative Attributes Indicative of Pre-Order Campaign Success on Crowdfunding Platforms? A Text-Mining Approach." *17th Midwest Association for Information Systems Conference (MWAIS), Omaha, Nebraska* (May 2022).

TEACHING

Teaching Interests

Operations Management; Supply Chain Management; Logistics, Transportation, and Warehouse Management; Modeling and Optimization of Business Decisions; Project Management; Information Systems; Digital Economy and Platform Operations; Business Analytics; Data Analysis and Forecasting; Database Management; Machine Learning; Text Mining; Programming (Python, R, C, and C++); and Artificial Intelligence and Agentic AI (focusing on their technical and strategic dimensions, business applications and risks, and impact on digital platform markets and operations).

Teaching Experience

Instructor – University of Kansas, School of Business

- BSAN 417 – Introduction to Statistical Modeling (Scheduled for Spring 2027)
- BSAN/SCM 415 – Data Analysis and Forecasting, (30 Students, Teaching Evaluations: 4.63/5, Fall 2025)
- BSAN/SCM 415 – Data Analysis and Forecasting, (29 Students, Teaching Evaluations: 4.15/5, Fall 2024)

Graduate Teaching Assistant – University of Kansas, School of Business

- BSAN 440 – Foundations in Business Analytics, (Spring 2026, Spring 2025, Fall 2022)
- BSAN 416 – Modeling and Optimization of Business Decisions, (Fall 2026, current)
- BSAN/SCM 415 – Data Analysis and Forecasting, (Spring 2024, Fall 2023, Spring 2022)
- SCM 403 – Logistics, Transportation, and Warehouse Management, (Spring 2023)
- BSAN 326 – Database Management Systems, (Fall 2021)

Note: The BSAN and SCM courses listed above are undergraduate offerings within the Business Analytics and Supply Chain Management programs, respectively.

HONORS AND AWARDS

- HICSS Doctoral Fellow, Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences (HICSS), 2026
- John O. Tollefson Doctoral Student Teaching Award, University of Kansas, 2026
- Max E. Fessler Dissertation Award, University of Kansas, 2025

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Referee for Journals

- Journal of Business Analytics (JBA), 2026
- Reproducibility Reviewer, Management Science Reproducibility Project (ManSciReP), 2023

Referee for Conferences

- International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS), 2024–2026

Session Co-Chair

- POMS Annual Conference, 2027

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming and Analytics: Python, R, SQL, C/C++, Stata.

Data Science and AI: scikit-learn, NLP and LLM APIs, PyTorch/TensorFlow, text mining, causal inference, generative-AI application development (Streamlit).

Tools: Git, Excel, Mathematica, Tableau/Power BI, LaTeX.

Developed AI Tool: BSAN Model Building Workbench (https://bsanmodelworkbench.streamlit.app/).

Note: BSAN Model Building Workbench. Developed and integrated an open-source tool for structured human–AI collaboration in BSAN/SCM 415. Guides students through six analytics-project stages, records AI output, student verification, and revisions, and includes a Socratic AI coach with exportable, gradable interaction logs.

WORKING EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder, Food Bus Project, Shanghai, China, 2015

A campus-area food delivery startup. Designed and operated food bus routes connecting restaurants near campus and surrounding student residence halls.

Product Development and Marketing Intern, Royal DSM, Shanghai, China, 2013–2014

Conducted market analysis in Shanghai and Beijing to support product strategy and assisted in new nutrition product development**.**

REFERENCES

Available upon request.